

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 9

New Patient: Meera – Highly Detailed Version
Full Detailed – Realistic Style with Greater Depth

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Meera (28 years, Female, High School Teacher, Therapist)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	9 of 16–18	Focus:	Action Plan & Relapse Prevention

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client arrived looking extremely fatigued. She spoke very little at the beginning and took longer pauses than usual. She completed the diary on 4 days and managed only one small activity (making tea mindfully). She expressed strong hopelessness and self-criticism. Today's plan: Explore her experience with Behavioral Activation in depth, continue relapse prevention planning (Action Plan if symptoms return), continue cognitive restructuring with more depth, and assign very manageable homework.

SESSION START – CHECKING IN

Therapist: Good morning, Meera. It's good to see you. How have you been feeling since our last session?

Client: (speaking slowly, looking down) Same. Very tired. I did the tea thing once. I tried to notice small things but mostly forgot. I feel like nothing is changing and I'm just wasting everyone's time.

Therapist: (speaking gently and slowly) It sounds like this week has been really heavy and discouraging for you. I can hear how hopeless and frustrated you're feeling, and how much self-criticism is coming up. It takes a lot of strength to keep showing up when everything feels pointless. I want you to know that what you're describing — the extreme fatigue, the harsh inner voice, the sense that nothing is changing — is very real and very common in depression. It doesn't mean you're failing. Would it be okay if we looked at what happened with the small activities without judging yourself too harshly?

Client: (quietly) Okay.

EXPLORING THE HOMEWORK EXPERIENCE IN DEPTH

Therapist: You mentioned you only managed to make tea mindfully once this week. Can you tell me what happened on the days you didn't do it? What thoughts or feelings came up when you thought about trying?

Client: (after a long pause) Most days I would wake up already feeling exhausted. I would think about the homework and immediately feel this heaviness in my chest. The thought that came was "Why bother? It's not going to make any difference anyway." So I would just get ready for school and try to survive the day. By the time I came home, I had no energy left for anything.

Therapist: That sounds incredibly difficult. When that thought "Why bother? It's not going to make any difference" came up, how did it affect your energy and motivation in that moment?

Client: It made everything feel even heavier. Like there was no point in even trying. So I didn't try. And then later I would feel angry at myself for not doing it.

Therapist: So the thought led to even lower motivation, which led to not doing the activity, which then led to self-criticism and more heaviness. This is a very painful cycle. And it makes complete sense that you would feel stuck in it. Does seeing it this way help at all, or does it still feel like you're just failing?

Client: (quietly) A bit. I can see how the thoughts are making it harder. But I still feel like I should be able to push through it.

CONTINUING RELAPSE PREVENTION – ACTION PLAN

Therapist: Last session we started identifying your Early Warning Signs. Today, let's build on that by creating an **Action Plan** — what you will actually do when you notice several warning signs for more than a few days. This is something you can use even after therapy ends. Would that be okay?

Client: (quietly) I guess. It feels a bit overwhelming, but I guess it's good to have a plan.

Therapist: That's completely fair. We'll take it slowly. Let's develop your Action Plan together. This is what you will do when early warning signs appear for more than a few days.

Action Plan we developed together:

1. Increase use of daily diary + very small activities for 1 week
2. Review Early Warning Signs list and Coping Card daily
3. Talk to someone (even briefly) instead of completely withdrawing
4. If symptoms do not improve after 7–10 days or significantly affect work/relationships → Contact therapist for a booster session

Client: This feels a bit overwhelming, but I guess it's good to have something concrete.

CONTINUING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING WITH DEPTH

Therapist: Last session your belief in "I'm not good enough as a teacher" was around 65%. How much do you believe it now?

Client: Still around 65%. It hasn't changed much.

Therapist: That's okay. These beliefs often take time and repeated real-life experiences to shift. The small activities and daily evidence collection will help gradually. We don't need to force it.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue the daily mood + thought diary (even 4 entries is completely fine)
2. Notice and write down ****one small thing**** you did each day (even basic things like reaching school, making tea, or brushing your teeth)
3. Practice using your Early Warning Signs list and Action Plan when you notice signs
4. Continue rating your belief in the old thought and use the balanced thought

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we explored your experience with the small activities in more depth, and we developed a clear Action Plan for when symptoms return. How does having this plan feel?

Client: It feels a bit overwhelming, but I guess it's good to have something concrete.

Therapist: That's completely fair. Any questions?

Client: No.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client continues to have very low energy and success with activities — realistic for depression.
- Continued relapse prevention planning (Action Plan) with realistic mixed feelings from client.
- Belief in old thought remains stable around 65%.
- Next session: Review Action Plan use, continue relapse prevention planning, continue cognitive restructuring with more depth.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.